

Meeting Minutes

Name of Committee: Devotion School Building Committee

Meeting Date: 14 July 2015 Time: 8:00 a.m. Meeting Location: Room 103, Town Hall.

Attendees: See attached sign-in sheets.

Next Meetings: 4 August 2015 at 8:00 a.m. in Town Hall Room 103.

Topic: Meeting Minutes

Motion to approve the minutes of 22 May 2015. ***Unanimously approved, P. Roberts abstained.***

Topic: DESE Submittal:

P. Lewis presented the proposed submission to DESE (via MSBA). From the initial submission, DESE provided direction to relocate the cluster of TLC rooms at the Stedman Street wing. After meetings with the school administration and staff, the architect included in the current submission moving CLL and LC closer to the kindergarden wing. The Stedman wing of the building is now pushed a little closer toward the street. Two bathrooms in CLL have been eliminated in favor of more program space, which is preferred by staff.

The proposed program changes have had the unintended but welcome side effect of giving the design team an opportunity to simplify the structural design of parts of the building. This may make the building a little easier to build and may slightly reduce cost.

Motion to approve the DESE submittal and to authorize the Owner's Project Manager to submit it to the MSBA. ***Unanimously approved, fifteen (15) votes yes, three (3) not in attendance at meeting.***

Topic: Building Elevations Drawings:

A discussion took place regarding the formal appointment of a Design Advisory Team (DAT) by the Planning Board for the project. The next project meeting of 4 August 2015 will be a combined meeting of the Planning Board and the Building Committee. In this way, both entities will be shown updated design drawings concurrently. It is expected that the DAT will be established at that time. It will take the place of the informal architectural design working group. The DAT will also address prescribed issue such as any zoning relief and make recommendations to the Zoning Board of Appeals (ZBA). At this time it is anticipated that any relief needed for parking, height and setbacks would be a special permit, not a variance.

HMFH staff then presented the current elevations drawings; they are the same as had been shown to the smaller architectural design working group on 30 June 2015. The

drawings are a work in progress; the design team received a number of very good comments from that meeting and is working to address them.

Currently, there are two options, both relying heavily on masonry veneer. Overall the comments received to date is that most like Option 1 the best, but there are features from Option 2 that are liked as well. Among the strategies of the design team is to adopt some features of Option 2 to see how well they may be incorporated into Option 1.

The basic layout of the building footprint is a large “H” with the longer bars along Stedman Street and near Babcock Street, which house most of the core academic spaces. The center of the building houses shared spaces and most administrative functions. In either option, to help reduce the scale of the two wings, windows are in a vertical orientation and both wings are comprised of three sections separated by glass “knuckles”. The window layout at the wings are reversed between the two options. The long stretches of building are “bookended” with staircases which are articulated differently in either option.

Some things under consideration for Option 1 include limiting the colors to two, rather than three or at least use of the third color as an accent only. Also, elimination of the use of the darker brick, or in Option 1 using it in the center portion rather than the rear section toward the play area. The staircases will be considered for articulation of fenestration, volume and location. They may also be furthered as “green” walls similar to that which is at the parking garage.

The courtyard elevations in either option are intended to frame the 1913 Building and help it stand out from the rest of the building. One option has more use of glass than the other. For elevations, studies will be furthered to determine the utility of sun screens and how they will be incorporated into the design where they are deemed necessary.

Among the goals is to bring order and calm to the design of the rear elevation which currently appears to be too “busy” and disordered. This should be achieved without sacrificing completely a whimsical feeling that may be of interest to children. The design team will be working on colors, fenestration, organization, stairwell and material choices.

All noted that the images shown are not likely to be how one would perceive the elevations in reality as many are shown orthogonally and/or at a distance that is never achievable given the realities of the site and its surroundings (with the possible exception of the playground elevation).

Topic: Site Design

HMFH staff then presented the site drawings, reflecting changes made since meeting with the Fire Chief. The key is that NFPA regulations of January 2015 require enhanced access into the site for fire apparatus. Among the changes are that access lanes shall be twenty (20) feet wide instead of eighteen (18) feet and any drive into the site that exceeds 150 feet must include a means for a vehicle to turn around so that it need not back out of

the site. The design team confident the changes can be done so that they become incorporated in the children's play area. For example, the asphalt may be painted to be interesting and/or interactive. The "doughnut hole" in the turn-around may house structured play equipment. Examples were shown of these.

The water play is proposed to be retained as the same size as currently shown but moved further from the building and closer to Stedman Street to make it more accessible to the community. The team is also looking at moving the soccer field closer to Stedman to minimize retaining walls.

Another challenge is designing and specifying the structured play equipment so it meets the program needs but remains consistent with the public bid laws.

Finally, it was noted that work on site design must continue over the summer. The school principal is hosting staff working meetings on site over the summer in order to make recommendations to the Building Committee. The next meetings are July 30 and August 25, 2015; both commence at 9:00 a.m., and are at the school. All are invited.

Meeting Adjourned at approximately 10:00 a.m.

Respectfully submitted,
Anthony Guigli
Owner's Project Manager